



STATUS REPORT

Sierra Leone: status report

Edition of 2026-08-10 · 63 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-10 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/SLE/ledger.csv](#) (63 systems and instruments, 11 of them Not held). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Sierra Leone's digital state is built on one register. The National Civil Registration Authority reports a biometric identity register covering [about 93% of the population](#), each holder with a unique [National Identification Number](#), and payments, banking and SIM registration are being wired onto it. The delivery gap is at the card: the World Bank recorded [under 0.5m cards issued against 6.4m NIN holders in 2024](#), and no issuance figure has been published since.

Two identity architectures are being stood up at once. The ministry is building a credential layer with Bhutan's National Digital Identity and the SIGN Foundation, [specified as MOSIP-based with W3C verifiable credentials](#); the registrar states its own [MOSIP pilot is complete and full implementation unfunded](#), and has warned publicly against parallel systems.

No data-protection law is in force. Cabinet [approved a National Data Protection Policy and authorised a Bill on 21 April 2026](#); it has not been tabled.

Connectivity is the constraint the state names itself: [about US\\$400m invested against a 60% usage gap](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
CSquared West Africa backbone and 2Africa West capacity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2Africa West capacity added to the operator's West Africa network, July 2026
National fibre backbone (SALCAB)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Backbone reported in 14 of 16 districts
Second submarine cable landing	PLANNED ↗	MoCTI delegation assessed feasibility and public-private models
Sierratel relaunch as an MVNO	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Africell appointed investment partner, April 2026
SOGEB-Leonecom fibre interconnection at Pamelap	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Networks interconnected at the Pamelap border, June 2025
Spectrum licensing and management framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	NaTCA set out its asks at MWC Barcelona, March 2026
Starlink connectivity for 300 government health facilities	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	First site launched at the Julius Maada Bio Paediatric Centre of Excellence, 27 July 2026
Starlink licensed satellite service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Licensed since June 2024, with three local resellers

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Data Centre at NatCA headquarters	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Commissioned by President Bio, 17 April 2026
NCRA Tier III data centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported operating by the NCRA Director-General, 7 August 2026
Orange Bo backup data centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened by President Bio, 29 November 2025

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital estate	NOT HELD	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Six offences mapped onto the mobile-money scam in a published legal analysis, 23 July 2026
NaTCA consumer education campaign on online fraud	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Campaign set out by the Director-General, 28 July 2026
National Cyber Security Coordination Centre (NC3)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named as a delivery partner in the senior civil service cyber and AI training, March 2026
Regulator response to the 2026 cybersecurity incidents	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	NaTCA public notice confirming ongoing incidents, 30 July 2026

The backbone is built and under-used. Fibre reaches [14 of 16 districts](#), and the communications minister put the investment at [about US\\$400m against a 60% usage gap](#), naming affordability rather than coverage as the limit on use. Redundancy runs through neighbours and wholesale carriers: the [Pamelap interconnection with Guinea's SOGEB carries 42.5 Gbps](#), and CSquared [added 2Africa West capacity to the backbone that reaches Sierra Leone in July 2026](#). A second landing of its own has [not moved past feasibility since July 2025](#).

Satellite is filling the state's own gaps. Starlink has been licensed since June 2024, and the health ministry [began connecting a stated 300 government facilities on 27 July 2026](#) with no cost, funder, procurement route or data-residency arrangement published.

Hosting has doubled since 2025. Orange opened a [EUR 23m disaster-recovery replica of its Freetown facility in Bo on 29 November 2025](#), and the [National Data Centre at the NatCA headquarters was commissioned on 17 April 2026](#) after a build begun in 2015.

Cybersecurity institutions are ahead of the record about them. The regulator [confirmed ongoing incidents affecting digital services on 30 July 2026](#) with no attribution, no named service and no incident count, and its response to the fraud wave is [an advisory consumer-education campaign](#). No founding instrument, mandate or budget is held for the National Cyber Security Coordination Centre named in that response.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Government Service Bus and X-Road data exchange layer	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Ministry of Finance reported piloting a Data Exchange Layer on X-Road
Legal basis for data sharing between government registers	NOT HELD	—

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
MOSIP migration of the national identity system	PILOTING ↗	Pilot complete, full implementation still seeking funding
National digital identity platform (Bhutan NDI and SIGN Foundation)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Private-sector consultation on the trusted digital ID framework, 6 August 2026
National Identification Number and biometric identity register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	NCRA reported about 93% population coverage to the DPI consultation, 5 August 2026
SIM registration linked to the National Identification Number	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Government conceded the linkage is incomplete in a ministerial statement, 4 August 2026

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Afrimoney prepaid Visa card (Africell, with Ecobank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched May 2026, no bank account required
Flot payments platform and chatbot (Open Hub)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched April 2026 with a WhatsApp chatbot and QR settlement

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
MikashBoks Interest Plus savings product (with Ecobank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched November 2025 at 6% annual interest via app and USSD
National instant payment switch	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Instant phase launched 13 February 2025, full integration from 1 April 2025
Orange Money virtual Mastercard (with Zenith Bank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched March 2026 through the Maxit app
Vult multi-currency wallet and card (Velmie, Metro Cable)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched April 2025 with a Visa card and merchant acceptance
Bank of Sierra Leone RTGS and ACH re-platforming	NOT HELD	2026-08-10

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National Digital Farmer Registry	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Integration with the NIN system agreed with the Ministry of Agriculture, May 2025

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital health information system and electronic medical records	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Connectivity rollout launched at the first facility, 27 July 2026

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Electronic government procurement platform	PLANNED ↗	NPPA delegation studied Liberia's e-GP system, 6-7 August 2026

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digitalisation of local councils	NOT HELD	—

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Coordination and Visualization Platform (DSTI with Catholic Relief Services)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Platform launched 6 July 2026 under a geospatial memorandum of 30 June 2026
National base map (DSTI with JICA and Aero Toyota)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Development announced with a feasibility mission still ahead, 4 August 2026

Identity is the most complete layer and the most contested. The NCRA reports [about 93% coverage on a unique National Identification Number, a Tier III data centre and a live eKYC platform](#), and states its [MOSIP pilot is complete and full implementation still seeking funding](#). The ministry's track is a credential layer over that register, [MOSIP-based with W3C verifiable credentials under a memorandum signed in June 2026](#) with Bhutan's National

Digital Identity and the SIGN Foundation; no framework, legal instrument or timetable has been published. The registrar has argued in public that the register already enrolled should be the anchor. The two positions have not been reconciled.

Interoperability is at pilot stage. The Ministry of Finance is [piloting a data exchange layer on X-Road](#), following a World Bank [terms of reference for a Government Service Bus prototype](#); no production date or connected agency list is published, and no instrument governing exchanges between registers is held.

Payments are interoperable at the rail and crowded at the wallet. The [instant phase of the national switch launched on 13 February 2025 with seven banks and two mobile operators](#), and the central bank awarded contracts on 4 August 2026 to re-platform both national rails — [US\\$1,869,000 for real-time gross settlement](#) and [US\\$3,194,615 for automated clearing](#) — with neither supplier nor scope published. Five card and wallet products have launched above that rail since April 2025, most recently the [Afrimoney prepaid Visa card in May 2026](#).

Sector registers are thinner. The National Digital Farmer Registry has [no enrolment figure published since its NIN integration was agreed in May 2025](#), and electronic medical records exist as [an announced programme with one facility connected](#). Geospatial capability is newer: a [platform launched on 6 July 2026 with Catholic Relief Services](#) and a [national base map with Japanese support, announced 4 August 2026 with no cost, timetable, hosting arrangement or data licence stated](#).

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Electronic Transactions Act 2019	IMPLEMENTED, NOT OPERATIONALISED ↗	Public-private dialogue convened to operationalise it, 27-28 July 2026
National Communications Authority Act 2022	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Tested against the mobile-money fraud wave in a published legal analysis, 23 July 2026
Subscribers Regulations 2025 (SIM-NIN enforcement)	IMPLEMENTED, TRANSITION RUNNING ↗	Phase-out of unregistered SIMs announced, 30 July 2026
Allocation of loss for mobile-money fraud	NOT HELD	2026-08-04

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Multi-agency response to mobile-money fraud	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Ministerial statement to Parliament, 4 August 2026
National Data Protection Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved by Cabinet, 21 April 2026
National Data Strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Updated over five months with DIAL support, aligned to the AU Data Policy Framework

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone free roaming	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Took effect 2 May 2025

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Sierra Leone-Guinea free roaming agreement	PLANNED ↗	Signed at Transform Africa 2025

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National open-source software policy for the public sector	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved 2025

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Cabinet approved the policy and authorised the Bill, 21 April 2026
Right to Access Information Commission	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cabinet authorised repeal of its Act and a merged dual-mandate authority
NCRA-SLRSA register-to-register data-sharing agreement	NOT HELD	—
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	NOT HELD	—

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
European Union digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	NOT HELD	—

There is no data-protection law in force. Cabinet [approved a National Data Protection Policy and authorised a Data Protection and Right to Access Information Act on 21 April 2026](#), repealing the Right to Access Information Commission Act and merging both functions into one authority with investigative and enforcement powers; the Bill is to be finalised with the Attorney-General and tabled, with no parliamentary date set. The draft [completed national validation in November 2025](#), and the policy text is not published. Sierra Leone's bilateral health agreement with the United States, and the data-sharing agreement attached to it, are [withheld and in litigation](#) since 2 April 2026.

The Electronic Transactions Act was [assented and commenced on 5 December 2019](#), and a public-private dialogue of 27-28 July 2026 was convened [to establish the certification authorities, evidence procedures, dispute mechanisms and penalties that were never created](#), producing a gap analysis, a policy memorandum and an implementation roadmap, none of them adopted. It worked to [functional equivalence and technological neutrality](#). The Act as enacted and gazetted is not held.

A legal analysis of 23 July 2026 finds that the [National Communications Authority Act 2022 addresses its enforcement powers to licensees](#), leaving foreign platforms outside the perimeter, and that no statutory reversal mechanism or refund duty exists; a former minister argues the [central bank's existing know-your-customer rules are](#)

adequate and only enforcement is missing. The two accounts have not been reconciled. The government's answer, set out to Parliament on 4 August 2026, is public education, institutional strengthening and better investigation, with no liability rule proposed.

The Subscribers Regulations 2025 fine operators 25,000 new leones for each unregistered or pre-activated SIM, on a transition clock presented as running from the announcement of 30 July 2026, so the phase-out date is unestablished; the instrument's text is not held.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
AI-in-government partnership with Qhala	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Memorandum signed at UNGA80, October 2025
Deepfake and digital misinformation campaign	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Running since May 2026, seven towns reached
National AI Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft AI Readiness Diagnostic produced and consultations run

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Millennium Challenge Corporation compact dispatch centres and SCADA upgrades	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Provided for in the Sierra Leone compact

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Indian digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	NOT HELD	—

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Gulf state digital investment in Sierra Leone	NOT HELD	—

Artificial intelligence policy is at the drafting stage. MoCTI, with the World Bank, is developing a first National AI Strategy and has produced a draft AI readiness diagnostic, with consultations run on local languages; nothing has been adopted. The capacity route runs through a memorandum with Qhala signed in October 2025 to train 500 civil servants and build 10-15 AI workflows; training has been reported and workflow delivery has not.

Synthetic media is being addressed by literacy rather than by rule. A deepfake and digital-misinformation campaign has run since May 2026 across seven towns, with broadcast programming and a verification chatbot announced as the next phase and no budget, funder or completion date stated. No legislative or platform-facing instrument accompanies it.

The only industrial application on the ledger is the [dispatch centres and SCADA upgrades provided for in the Millennium Challenge Corporation compact](#), with no commissioning or delivery report published.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Human intermediation in identity enrolment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Documented in an ethnographic study published March 2026
Starlink connectivity for universities	IMPLEMENTED ↗	12 universities connected through ELCOME SL under the National Broadband Strategy 2023-2028

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Civil service digital skills programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched July 2026 with 1,000 places in year one
Digital Public Goods university curriculum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First academic Digital Public Goods exhibition held, 27 July 2026

External finance carries the programme. The World Bank Board [approved the US\\$137m WARDIP2 operation on 13 March 2026](#) across Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, targeting 5.2m people connected and digital skills training for 9,000; the Sierra Leone share is not disclosed. The domestic counterpart is a target: the Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund is stated as [US\\$150m over five years with no amount raised](#). No appropriation for the digital sector is held.

Skills work is running at two levels. A [civil service digital skills programme launched in July 2026 with 1,000 places in year one](#) and stated targets of 3,000 and 5,000; in the universities, a curriculum built with UNICEF, the United Nations University and Limkokwing has [taught more than 1,100 students and produced 11 student solutions evaluated against the Digital Public Goods Standard](#), on campuses whose connectivity is bought from a satellite operator — [12 universities through ELCOME SL](#), with no further site count reported.

Access remains uneven at both ends of the identity chain. Enrolment of the undocumented depends on [chiefs, teachers and justices of the peace issuing affidavits the NCRA accepts at face value](#), per an ethnographic study published in March 2026, while the card that enrolment produces has [no issuance figure published since 2024](#).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund	PLANNED ↗	Target stated at the Digital Public Goods exhibition, 27 July 2026
WARDIP2 regional digital integration operation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	World Bank Board approved the US\$137m operation, 13 March 2026

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	NOT HELD	—

(narrative not yet written)

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Allocation of loss for mobile-money fraud	Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law; unreconciled as at 2026-08-09.	not yet probed
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital estate	A staffing, skills-audit or operations report from NaTCA, DSTI or the NCRA covering who runs the national systems and with what capacity.	not yet probed
Digitalisation of local councils	A local government digital plan, a council-level service platform, or a district administration report on digital service delivery.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Sierra Leone.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Sierra Leone.	not yet probed
Gulf state digital investment in Sierra Leone	An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	The Ministry of Finance appropriation act or budget speech showing the votes for MoCTI, NaTCA, DSTI and the NCRA.	not yet probed
NCRA-SLRSA register-to-register data-sharing agreement	The signed agreement or a published summary stating what data classes flow, on what legal basis and with what retention limit.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for data sharing between government registers	A data-sharing instrument, regulation or protocol governing exchanges between the identity register and other agencies.	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Sierra Leonean government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

Ten rows carry no reliable statement of position. Six are subject areas the base holds nothing on: local government digitalisation, domestic technical capacity, digital-sector appropriations, and European Union, Indian and Gulf state cooperation. Four are documents the record points at and does not contain — the NCRA's data-sharing agreement with the road safety authority, any instrument setting the legal basis for exchanges between registers, any rule allocating loss for mobile-money fraud, and the bilateral health agreement with the United States.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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